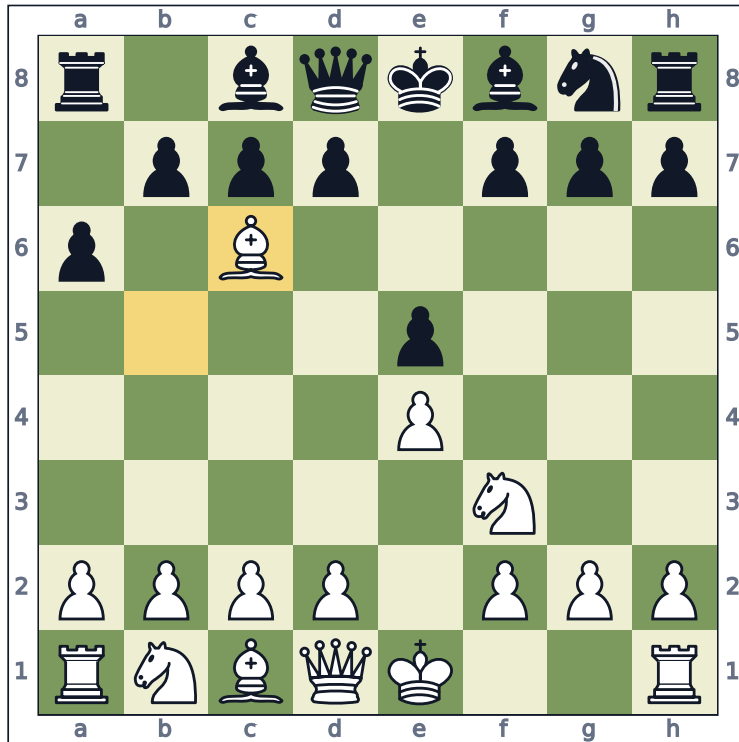


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Ruy Lopez

ECO C68 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.21 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C68 covers Ruy Lopez. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Ruy Lopez: Exchange Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. White is ahead by about 3 pawn units. Central markers: White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C68 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to C68 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Ruy Lopez: Exchange Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6

002 Ruy Lopez: Exchange Variation, Alekhine Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. d4 exd4 6. Qxd4 Qxd4 7. Nxd4 Bd6

003 Ruy Lopez: Exchange Variation, Keres Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. Nc3

004 Ruy Lopez: Exchange Variation, Lutikov Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 bxc6

005 Ruy Lopez: Exchange Variation, Romanovsky Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. Nc3 f6 6. d3

006 Ruy Lopez: Exchange, Alekhine Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. d4 exd4 6. Qxd4 Qxd4 7. Nxd4 Bd7